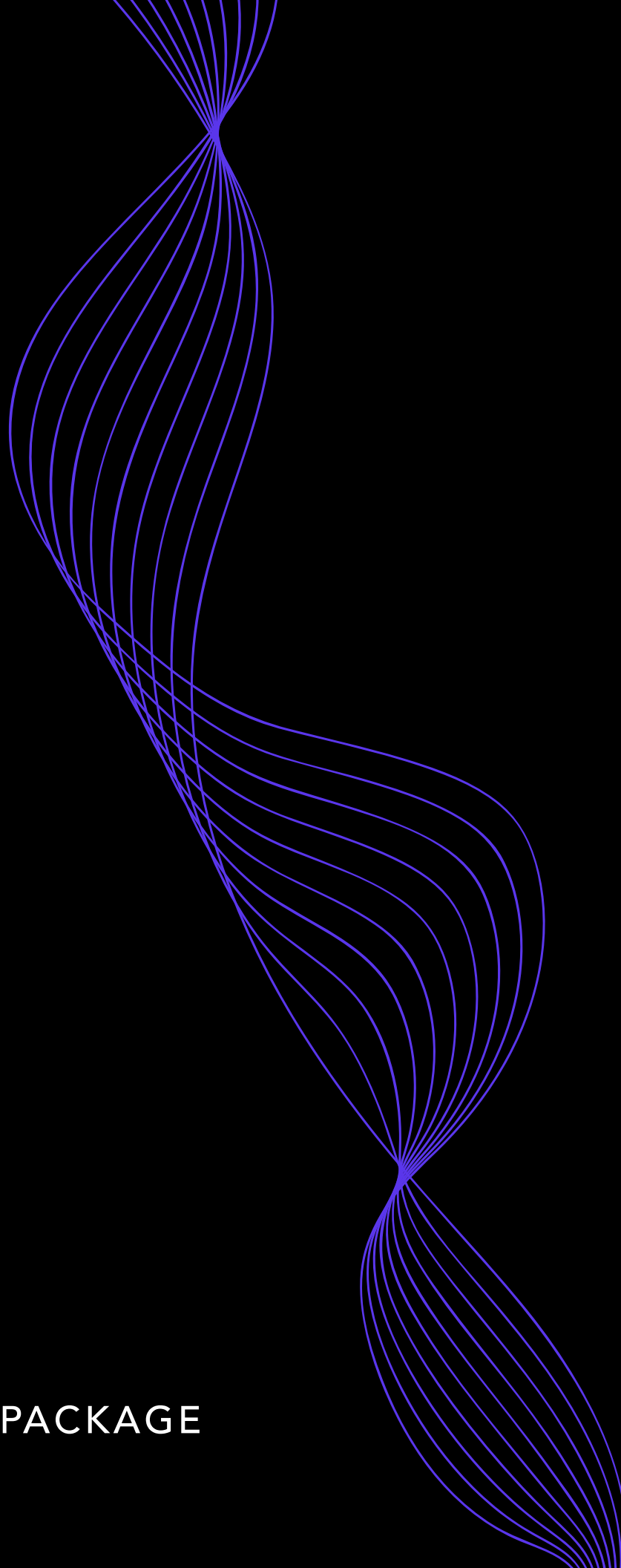


DMZ

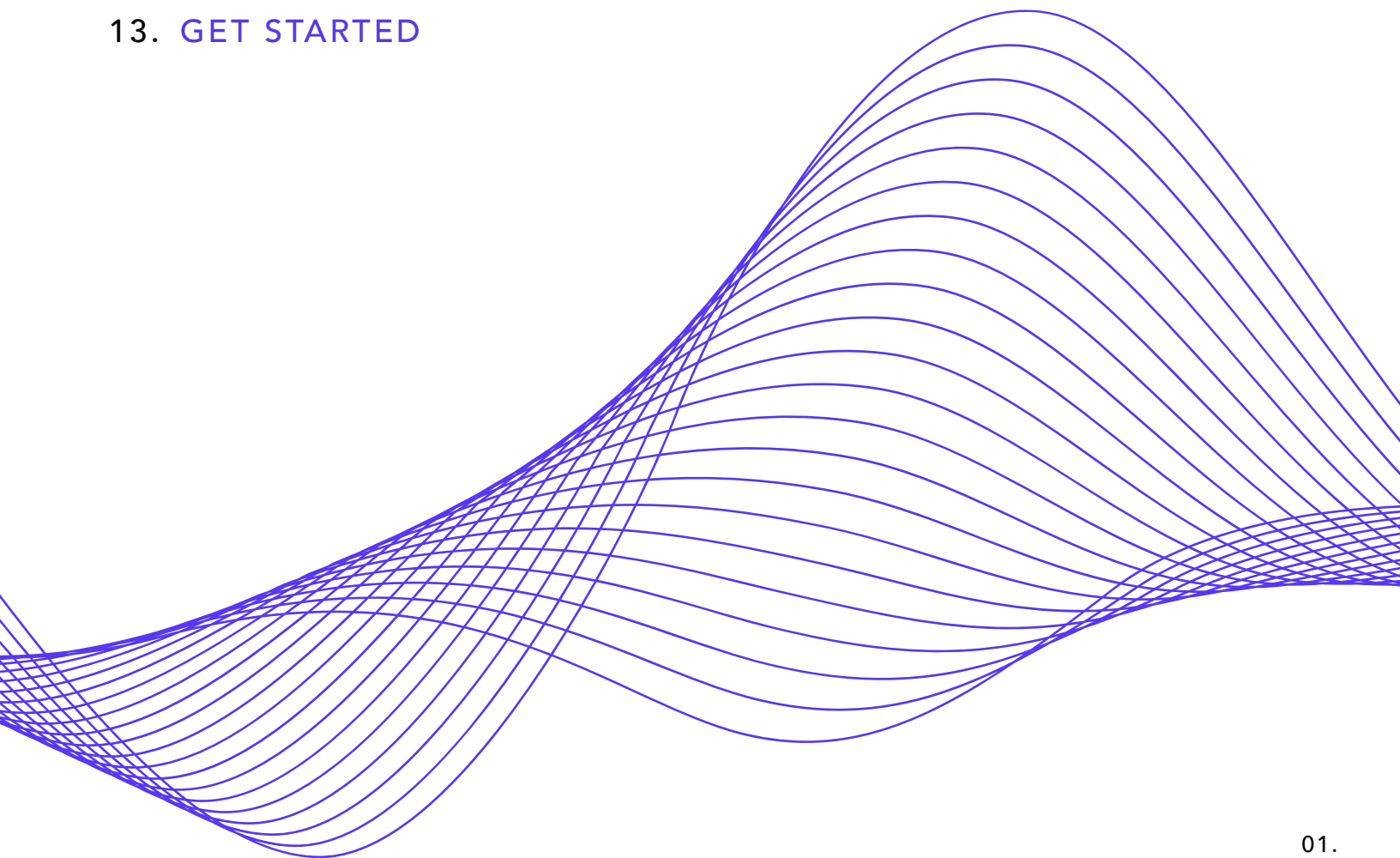


2025

INCUBATOR PROGRAM PACKAGE

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A world-leading incubator.

○ **2400+**
BUSINESSES INCUBATED

○ **\$2.94B**
IN TOTAL FUNDING RAISED

○ **15+**
COUNTRIES FOUNDERS CAN ACCESS
INTERNATIONAL MARKETS AND OFFICES

DMZ's Incubator is an 18-month, equity-based program designed for the unique needs of venture-backable, seed-stage startups. Our customized support transforms early-stage companies with high potential into market leaders with proven business models.

Joining DMZ provides founders with a tailored array of services and resources designed to accelerate their business growth.



Incubator program at a glance.

Admission into our Incubator program opens doors to endless mentorship opportunities with industry leaders, connects founders to a community of driven entrepreneurs, and offers a wealth of resources specifically curated to enhance their business journey. We provide everything from financial backing to legal guidance and active community involvement, tailoring our support to the unique demands of each startup.

AT A HIGH LEVEL, OUR SERVICES ENCOMPASS:

- One-on-one guidance from industry experts on strategy across several business domains
- Hiring support and grants, and access to a broader tech talent pool
- Fundraising strategy and curated investor introductions
- Legal support, research and strategy sessions, contract drafting
- Customer connections, industry events and in-person introductions
- Financial support, access to grants and startup business savings
- 24/7 dedicated office space in downtown Toronto with full-service amenities
- International expansion and relocation to Canada
- A broad, diverse community of other entrepreneurs, mentors and DMZ alumni

Keep reading for a detailed programming overview.

EXPERT GUIDANCE

Get unlimited access to our network of 30+ Experts-in-Residence (EiRs) for personalized guidance and tactical support from industry experts.

Tackle your startup's growth challenges across various areas from sales processes, revenue growth, product design, pitch coaching, marketing, and beyond.

Tap into Group EiR sessions to benefit from the collective wisdom and expertise of multiple coaches, fostering a collaborative environment to bolster startup growth.



MARKETING
Gina Bowen



STRATEGY
Sultan Mehrabi



SCALING
Andrea Matheson



PRODUCT DESIGN
Jenn Nguyen



PRODUCT, SALES
Anthony Lau



CUSTOMER SUCCESS
Karen Hogg



STRATEGY
Martin Croteau



HR STRATEGY
Melissa Malcolm



SALES, PROCUREMENT, OPERATIONS



SENIOR TECH EXECUTIVE
Kareem Arafat

View all our Experts-in-Residence [here](#).



HIRING SUPPORT

Ease the hiring process and alleviate cost burdens with access to hiring grants and wage subsidies.

Access wage subsidies of 50% when hiring DMZ-trained students for co-ops or internships opportunity through the Startup Certified program.

Discover a broad tech talent pool via the DMZ Community Slack channel with 4,000+ members.



FUNDRAISING SUPPORT

Access an expansive investor network, encompassing over 3,000 angels and VCs from various backgrounds, ready to support diverse entrepreneurial ventures.

Leverage DMZ's deep investor portfolio knowledge for personalized 1:1 connections, helping you not only secure funding but also attract 'smart money' that aligns with your strategic objectives during fundraising rounds.

Get support exploring non-dilutive and alternative capital solutions for your business (ie. debt, RBF, etc).

Receive thorough fundraising preparation support to confidently and successfully navigate the fundraising process: deck preparation, lead list curation, data room reviews, making strategic introductions and more.

LEGAL SUPPORT

Access comprehensive legal support tailored for startups, including guidance on incorporating, drafting or amending Articles of Incorporation, and creating Customary by-laws.

Receive hands-on support preparing a range of legal documents, including: Shareholder and Employment Agreements, Stock Option Plans, Independent Contractor, Confidentiality Agreements, and Advisor and Non-Disclosure Agreements.

Receive hands-on support developing your Terms of Service and Privacy Policies for your websites to ensure compliance and protect your assets.

Get help conducting thorough legal research and strategy sessions, along with detailed contract reviews, to foster growth, ensure compliance with the law, and reduce costs.



CUSTOMER ACQUISITION AND SALES SUPPORT

Land customer connections and forge new deals and pilot partnerships through DMZ Connect, a network that spans diverse organizations, including large corporations and government bodies.

Tap into DMZ Connect's sector-specific industry events, pitch opportunities and office hours to engage with key industry players and enhance your business reach.

Receive customized coaching on customer acquisition strategies, sales targets and pitch deck refinement geared towards your specific business needs.

ADDITIONAL SUPPORT

Access grants and tax credits such as SR&ED, SWPP, OCI, NRC Industrial Research and more.

Tap into a specialized portal that lists all the relevant grants available in the market you qualify for.

Get dedicated help from an Expert-in-Residence (EiR) for assistance with the grant application process.



INTERNATIONAL EXPANSION

Get support expanding your business globally through DMZ's international locations and partnerships with access to office spaces, investor networks, customer networks, mentors, and a wide range of additional resources.

Access introductions to trade commissioners, support for localization and special requests, as well as cost-effective go-to-market consulting.

Get on-demand access to office and meeting space at DMZ's NYC headquarters in the heart of Manhattan's financial district.

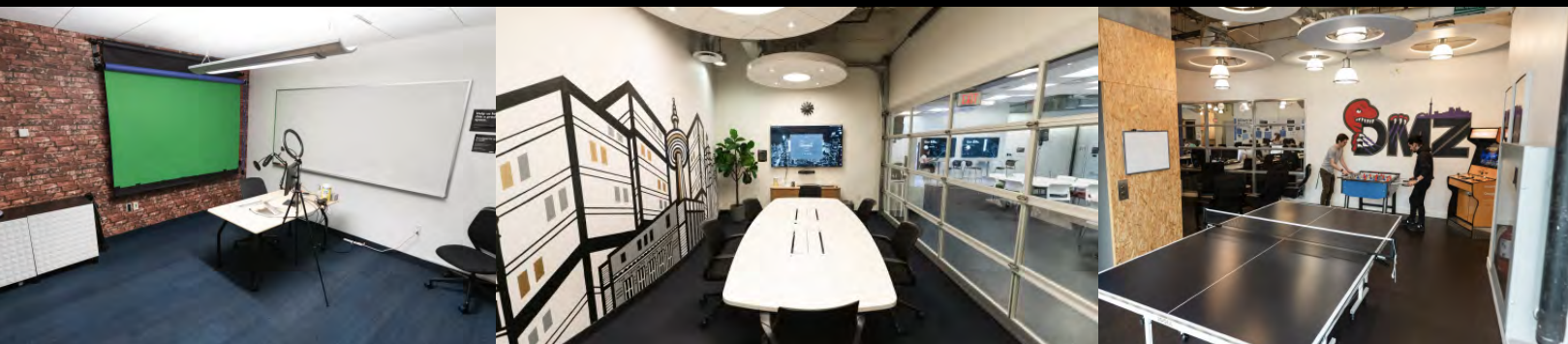
WORKSPACE

Get 24/7 access to dedicated workspace for you and your team at DMZ HQ in Downtown Toronto.

Make startup life easier with amenities including front desk mailing services, weekly catered lunches, unlimited snacks and coffee, showers facilities, a games room, a nap room, and more.

Book meeting spaces of various sizes, equipped with modern presentation amenities for internal and external meetings.

Leverage state-of-the-art meeting room amenities and equipment, including recording studio equipped with softbox lights, teleprompter, soundproofing, sound recording equipment, an onsite 3D printer and more.



OTHER EXCLUSIVE BENEFITS AND OPPORTUNITIES

- Get access to a vast array of professional services through benefits like pro bono office hours, discounted fees and workshops through Professionals-in-Residence like Logan Katz, Goodmans, BackStretch Recruitment Group and Humi, and other DMZ partners like Desjardins, Scotiabank, FedEx, TELUS and many more.
- Save money on business software and programs through 100+ exclusive benefits valued at \$1 million worth of discounted perks through partners like AWS, Google Cloud, Bookmark, Notion and more.
- Gain value from Monthly Founder Meetups, EiR-guided sessions to help you connect with other startup founders to celebrate successes, discuss challenges and exchange valuable insights, ensuring that every participant gains practical insights to apply to their ventures.
- Take part in workshops, Founder Talks and Ask-Me-Anything (AMA) sessions to gain tangible learnings to accelerate both your business and professional growth.
- Tap into the 5000+ members of our community through access to the DMZ Community Slack workspace, including fellow entrepreneurs, DMZ alumni, partners and investors to get in on conversations about business opportunities, events, hiring, fundraising and more.
- Receive free virtual therapy and consulting sessions for both you and your team members through **Inkblot**. Sessions are confidential and usernames are not shared with DMZ.
- Access a vast library of practical, short-form educational videos covering various entrepreneurship topics, from marketing and fundraising to company registration in Canada, used for your own benefit or to support your staff onboarding into the startup ecosystem.

Incubator criteria.

BUSINESSES ELIGIBLE FOR DMZ'S INCUBATOR MUST:

01. Be dedicated to solving a compelling problem using innovative technology
02. Have functional product with proven market validation
03. Have least one full-time founder who can be dedicated to the program and an in-house technical lead
04. Have driven, coachable, and collaborative leadership team
05. Be venture-backable and have the potential to become a scalable business in a growing market
06. Have traction in the form of MRR, number of paying customers, signed contracts or LOIs that would demonstrate market interest

APPLICATION AND ACCEPTANCE PROCESS:



Initial application submission: Founders submit their application through the [DMZ portal](#).

Application review: The DMZ team reviews each application and provides brief feedback. If a founder's application doesn't align with the program, they are informed of the reasons.

Screening call: Founders meeting the preliminary requirements are invited for a 20-minute call to demo their product and pitch their business to the DMZ team.

Deep dive sessions: Candidates who pass the screening call undergo in-depth sessions conducted at the beginning of the program. Each startup is comprehensively analyzed each from four major perspectives: Product & Tech, Business Strategy, Legal, Financial.

Final acceptance: Following all deep dive sessions, successful startups will receive their final acceptance into DMZ's Incubator and begin onboarded.

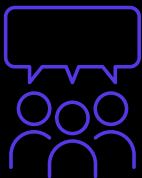
Program format.

Once accepted into the program founders gain access to all our support and services for 18 months. As an outcome of the deep dive sessions, DMZ provides founders with a comprehensive assessment of their business, pinpointing areas that need attention and detailing how DMZ can provide targeted support.



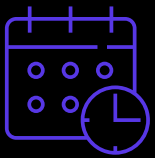
Time commitment:

Typically, startups need to dedicate ~4-5 hours monthly to program activities, excluding personalized 1:1 sessions they book with our Experts-in-Residence (EiRs) and other optional events and opportunities. As the program progresses, especially in months 7-18, the focus shifts towards expanding the customer base and connecting with investors, with a corresponding decrease in program intensity.



Quarterly board meetings:

Founders are required to take part in three quarterly board meetings with the DMZ team and their designated EiR to establish and evaluate business OKRs (Objectives and Key Results) set out each quarter. Here, DMZ will help the startup determine key business priorities and challenges, and seed the plan to address and execute on them.



Bi-weekly Program Lead check-ins:

Throughout the program, founders take part in bi-weekly sessions with their designated DMZ Program Lead, who acts as as their main point of contact for all DMZ resources. The Program Lead will help them execute on their business OKRs utilizing DMZ resources to foster company growth.

Boosted support for women founders.

Incubator startups with a woman founder receive additional boosted support:

- Access to a dedicated group of women Experts-in-Residence
- Exclusive pitch opportunities, including at DMZ's annual Women Founders Summit
- Introductions to funders and partners looking to support women-led startups
- Invites to women-focused events
- Amplified company exposure through DMZ marketing and PR opportunities
- Funding opportunities and guidance on international business expansion



500+

WOMEN FOUNDERS
SUPPORTED

\$522M

IN FUNDING RAISED BY
DMZ WOMEN FOUNDERS

1.4M

WORTH OF GRANTS
& SERVICES PROVIDED

Boosted support for Black founders.

Incubator startups with a Black founder receive additional boosted support:

- Access to a dedicated group of Black Experts-in-Residence
- Exclusive pitch opportunities, including at DMZ's annual Black Innovation Summit
- Introductions to funders and partners looking to support Black-led startups
- Additional legal support
- Invites to events focused on Black founders
- Amplified company exposure through DMZ marketing and PR opportunities
- Funding opportunities and guidance on international business expansion



1000+

BLACK FOUNDERS
SUPPORTED

\$3M+

IN FUNDING RAISED BY
DMZ BLACK FOUNDERS

\$2.2M

WORTH OF GRANTS
& SERVICES DISTRIBUTED
TO BLACK FOUNDERS



Get started.

HOW TO APPLY

New cohorts begin each Spring and Fall and applications are always open. Start your application by visiting dmz.to/apply.

APPLY HERE

CONTACT

We take pride in growing with our founders and offering a program that's tailored to their needs. If you require something that isn't included in this package, please don't hesitate to let us know.



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